Worksheet: build a skill with your team

Time: about 2 hours across three sprints. Work in pairs. Use invented or anonymised material only. Nothing confidential goes into a skill or its files.

A skill is a workflow written down once, with its checks. You will write one, test it, find its gaps, fix it and package it. It will never be finished, and that is the point.

Team members: _____ Skill name: _____

Sprint 1: build version one

Step 1. Choose the task

Pick one task you would do again next week. Good first choices: PQQ answer, tender compliance, meeting minutes to actions, method statement layout, toolbox talk, weekly site report.

Write it in one sentence: "This skill helps _____ to produce _____ from _____."

Write down the part a person must always do or check:

_____

Step 2. Gather your inputs

- One invented or anonymised example of the input (a tender extract, rough notes, a site scenario).
- One or two reference files the skill may use as facts (an answer bank, a house style guide).
- A description of what a good result looks like, in two or three lines.

Step 3. Let the model interview you

Start a new chat. Paste this and answer its questions one at a time:

```
I want to create a reusable skill for this task: [your sentence from step
1]. Interview me to work out what the skill needs. Ask one question at a
time. Cover: who uses it, what the input looks like, what a good result
looks like, which files it should use for facts, what it must never do,
and what a person must check before using the result. Stop after about
eight questions and summarise what you have learned.
```

Step 4. Ask it to draft the skill

Attach the skill template (or paste it). Then paste:

```
Using that summary and the attached template, write a SKILL.md for this
skill. Give it a short name with dashes and a description that says when
to use it and when not to. Write the steps in plain English in the order
they happen. Put the reference files under Facts to use. Fill in Limits
and Check before use. Mark anything you had to guess in [square brackets].
Do not invent facts.
```

Read the draft. Cross out anything that is wrong. Do not accept it as it stands.

Step 5. Add the guard

For anything about safety, quality or the environment, paste:

```
Add these rules to Limits, in the skill's own words. The skill must not
decide hazards or controls. It must mark anything unknown in [square
brackets]. It must never say a task is safe or compliant. It must end with
a checklist for the competent person to work through before signing.
```

For every other skill, ask: "What is the worst thing this skill could get wrong, and what limit would prevent it?"

Sprint 2: test it, swap it, fix it

Step 6. Run it on your example

Paste the example and say: "Use the skill we just wrote on this input." Check the result against your original, line by line. Write each gap in the log below.

Step 7. Swap with another team

Give your skill and your example to another pair. They run it, try one input of their own, and add every gap they find to your log. You do the same for theirs.

Step 8. Fix the skill

For each gap in the log, paste:

```
The skill produced this problem: [describe the gap]. Change the skill so
it does not happen again. Add or change only the lines that are needed and
show me exactly what changed.
```

Re-run the same example. Did the gap close? Write the change and the date in the change log.

Gaps log

Gap found (what went wrong)	Found by	Fix made to the skill	Fixed?

Sprint 3: package it

Step 9. Write the index

Make a one-page table with one row for each file your skill uses: what it contains, what to use it for, what not to use it for, its owner and when it was last updated. Add a line saying which file wins if two disagree. Ask the model to draft it, then check it.

```
Write a one-page index of these files in a table with columns: file, what
it contains, use it for, do not use it for, owner, last updated. Add a
line saying which file wins if two disagree. Mark anything you do not know
in [square brackets].
```

Step 10. Package it

Put your skill, and a second one if you have time, in a plugin if your plan allows. If it does not, keep the skill text and the index in a Project or your prompt library. Add a short description of what it is for.

Step 11. Name an owner and a review date

Owner: _____ Review date: _____
Review every three months at most, because the tools change.

What must never go into this skill or its files:

_____

Change log

Date	What changed	Approved by

Before you finish

- [ ] The skill says when to use it and when not to.
- [ ] Limits and Check before use are filled in.
- [ ] A person checks every figure and claim against the source.
- [ ] A safety skill never decides a hazard or a control.
- [ ] Another team has tried to break it.
- [ ] There is an index, an owner, a review date and a change log.